FRAMESHIFT / THE PRACTICAL DESIGN LIBRARY

Balcony & Terrace Renovation

A homeowner planning guide and contractor-question toolkit

Use this workbook to scope a tired balcony before hiring qualified professionals. The FrameShift rust-to-coffee visualization is an imaginative design example; no depicted material, connection, load or test has been verified for a real property.

- □ WHO THIS IS FOR: homeowners, tenants seeking permission, design clients and people preparing to interview contractors.
- □ WHAT IT IS: an educational planning resource with a clear brief, staged questions and printable worksheets.
- □ WHAT IT IS NOT: an engineered drawing set, statutory approval, DIY method statement, permit, warranty or proof that the filmed work actually happened.

Version 1.0 | 13 November 2026 | frameshift-transformations.onrender.com

Start with the brief

Complete these fields before requesting quotations. Work quality improves when every contractor is pricing the same scope.

Project address / city	_____
Owner / landlord permission	_____
Project goals (top 3)	_____
Existing problems / damage	_____
Budget ceiling and currency	_____
Target start / completion	_____
Must-keep features	_____
Decision maker / contact	_____

Universal pre-project checklist

- □ Identify the exact property and intended use; confirm whether you own the property or need landlord, homeowners' association or building-management consent.
- □ Take clear dated before photos, measure dimensions, note door/window clearance, and record existing damage or moisture problems.
- □ Obtain at least two itemised written quotations with materials, exclusions, schedule, payment milestones and warranty information.
- □ Check the relevant authority and building rules for the actual location. Online US or European references are useful questions to raise, not automatic local legal requirements.
- □ Never treat an AI video as documentation that any work was physically performed, inspected or tested.

1 / Decide what needs assessment

□ Request a condition survey covering slab edges, cracking, corrosion, water staining, loose finishes and evidence of past leaks.

□ Ask an appropriately qualified structural professional to evaluate any defective guardrail, structural steel, anchors, concrete spalling or suspected slab movement before design changes.

□ Document existing door threshold, wall-to-slab junctions, balcony dimensions, outlet/drain positions and adjacent interior finishes.

□ If older cement panels or coatings may contain asbestos, lead or other regulated hazards, stop disturbance and seek competent assessment. Never assume a video confirms the material.

2 / Safety, permissions and design

□ Determine who owns or controls the balcony structure and external appearance; obtain written permission for railing, cladding or drainage changes.

□ Require the guard, posts, anchors, glazing and fixing substrates to be designed/approved as an integrated system for local loads and height requirements.

□ Specify a plan for temporary edge protection throughout work, not only a finished guardrail.

□ Agree access, material lifting, dust containment, protection of neighbours and responsible waste disposal.

3 / Drainage and waterproofing

□ Have the designer identify the intended route for rainwater, relevant outlet positions and how falls, door thresholds and drainage details interact.

□ Ask which compatible waterproofing system is specified, including substrate preparation, penetrations, upstands, junctions, flashing and curing.

□ Require a documented inspection/test method suitable for the selected manufacturer system and property. A filmed 'flood test' does not prove a real leak test occurred.

□ Coordinate guardrail penetrations, metal connections and the membrane so they do not create leakage paths. Do not improvise waterproofing around anchors.

4 / Surface finish and sequencing

□ Ask the contractor to provide an order of operations for temporary protection, remediation, railing work, substrate repair, membrane, finishing and handover.

□ Review exterior-rated tile suitability, slip resistance, compatible adhesive/grout, movement joints and perimeter sealants with the chosen assembly.

□ Confirm water run-off is not obstructed by planters, thresholds, tile buildup or furnishings.

□ Require protection of completed waterproofing and tiles during subsequent glazing and furniture work.

5 / What to request at handover

- □ Written photos/record of concealed waterproofing, flashing, fixings and materials before they are covered.
- □ Applicable inspection approvals, manufacturer warranties, contractor guarantees, and repair/maintenance instructions.
- □ Demonstration of usable drainage and safe guard/door clearances as assessed by the relevant trades.
- □ List of excluded works and remaining defects, plus a contact for future leaks or corrosion.

Budget worksheet

Enter your local quotes and currency. No prices here are represented as accurate quotes for your location. Add a contingency suitable to the project and seek professional advice on unforeseen conditions.

Category	Quote / currency	Notes / exclusions
Condition / structural assessments	_____	_____
Permits / approvals	_____	_____
Temporary protection and access	_____	_____
Railing and glazing	_____	_____
Concrete and substrate repairs	_____	_____
Waterproofing and flashing	_____	_____
Exterior tiling and finishes	_____	_____
Lighting and furniture	_____	_____
Contingency (user-defined)	_____	_____
TOTAL	_____	_____

Ask the contractor before signing

- □ Who signs off the structural guard and anchors?
- □ How are thresholds, drains and membrane penetrations detailed?
- □ Which drawings and manufacturer instructions govern the work?
- □ What inspections/test records will be delivered before finishes are covered?
- □ Who is responsible for a leak discovered after handover?

Quote comparison

Contractor A / price / dates	_____
Contractor B / price / dates	_____
Scope difference / exclusions	_____
Licences / insurance checked	_____
References checked / follow-up	_____
Chosen contractor / why	_____

Before you sign off

- □ Scope and variations are itemised in writing
- □ Approval and technical signoffs appropriate for the site are collected
- □ Photographs and receipts for concealed or regulated works are retained
- □ Owner receives product manuals, maintenance instructions and warranties
- □ Defects list and remedy date are agreed
- □ Final payment milestones and retention are clarified in the signed contract
- □ AI-concept imagery is never used as evidence of work carried out

Further reading and source notes

Tile Council of North America — exterior FAQ

https://tcnatile.com/resource-center/faq/exteriors/

Schluter — balcony assemblies

https://eu.schluter.com/en-DE/balcony-assembly-a-1-covering-assembly-with-bonded-waterproofing-10201.html

EPA — remodeling and indoor air quality

https://www.epa.gov/indoor-air-quality-iaq/best-practices-indoor-air-quality-when-remodeling-your-home

Important scope notice

Different countries and municipalities use different codes, licences, permit processes and construction standards. The cited reference materials are educational starting points, not a statement that a particular standard legally governs your project. Structural, electrical, excavation, fall protection and water-safety decisions must be approved and performed by appropriately qualified local professionals.

FrameShift Transformations — Every space has a second story.